

1. Quoting Steve Yegge

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-04T00:42:45+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/4/steve-yegge/#atom-everything>

Gas Town was intended to be reusable, but I only ever wound up using it to build itself. Gas Town fell apart at the seams with Opus 4.7. Up through 4.6 it was working brilliantly. With 4.7 we saw the introduction of the "just two more things" tic, which prevented Opus from ever converging on being ready to do real work?it always wanted to fiddle with Gas Town itself. The Opus tic never went away, so Gas Town effectively burned down. It had other problems, too, but 4.7 was the final straw. ? Steve Yegge , The Shape of Things to Come Tags: steve-yegge , coding-agents , generative-ai , ai , llms

2. Don't be a meat proxy

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-03T23:45:04+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/3/dont-be-a-meat-proxy/#atom-everything>

Don't be a meat proxy Niklas Gruhn coins an excellent new term - meat proxy - for people who blindly copy and paste the output of AI systems to their peers. By all means, prompt AI. But don't just relay the output. Read it, understand it, validate it, and then write a response in your own words (a decent certificate that you've done the prior steps). Making that effort is value you can add. Via Lobste.rs Tags: definitions , ai , generative-ai , llms , ai-misuse

3. Quoting David Crawshaw's prompt

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-03T16:15:27+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/3/david-crawshaw/#atom-everything>

Set up a nightly cron job that executes the prompt: fetch upstream changes to the and rebase all local changes on top of upstream. Check that the software works as intended and replace the current version. ? David Crawshaw's prompt , Devtools must be open source Tags: prompt-engineering , coding-agents , generative-ai , ai , llms , open-source

4. TerminalWidget 1.0

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-04T02:32:33Z

Link: <https://terminalwidget.app/>

New app from Brett Terpstra: TerminalWidget lets you send output from commands, scripts, APIs, and Shortcuts directly to widgets across macOS, iOS, and iPadOS with rich formatting, progress bars, sparklines, and image support. It is available as a universal app on the App Store for \$19.99. I don't know what I'm going to use this for, but I know I want to use it. ?

5. [Sponsor] MCP vs. REST: The Right Way to Connect Agents to Your API

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-03T22:26:01Z

Link: https://workos.com/blog/mcp-vs-rest?utm_source=daringfireball&utm_medium=newsletter&utm_campaign=q32026

REST serves the developers building against your API. MCP serves the agents now trying to use it. Most teams treat these as competing standards and have to pick one. They're not rivals, they're layers: most MCP servers just call REST internally to do the real work. The best ones don't convert every endpoint into a tool, they design around what the agent's trying to accomplish. Shipping that server also means shipping OAuth 2.1 with scoped tokens. WorkOS AuthKit already speaks that spec , so you skip building an auth provider on top. Read the breakdown ? ?

6. John Ternus Has Rehired Former Hardware VP Laura Legros

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-03T22:01:41Z

Link: <https://www.macrumors.com/2026/08/03/apple-john-ternus-hiring-retired-vp/>

Juli Clover, MacRumors: Incoming Apple CEO John Ternus is rehiring Laura Legros, a former vice

president of hardware engineering who retired from Apple in 2022, reports Bloomberg . Legros previously managed product delivery, development schedules, and coordination across engineering teams. Under Ternus, she will work across different parts of the company, and report directly to him. According to Bloomberg, Legros was one of Ternus' most trusted deputies before she retired. She has presented at past Apple events, introducing the 2018 MacBook Air and the 2020 iPad Air. The 2018 introduction of the first retina MacBook Air was an interesting event . I noted at the time that it was conspicuous how seldom Apple mentioned 'Intel', despite the fact that all that products introduced ran on Intel chips. Then you look at the specs of that MacBook Air compared to the then-current iPad Pros (see link above) and you can see why Apple, privately, was seething. ?

7. Indirect lessons from human alignment

Source: DYNOMIGHT | Published: 2026-08-02T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://dynamight.net/human-alignment/>

(Inspired by a post from Eli Tyre .) Many people make some variant of the following argument: Evolution is an 'outer optimizer'. It is trying to make us maximize reproductive fitness. We are 'inner optimizers'. We just do what feels good. But what feels good has been set by evolution, which is hoping that it will make us maximize reproductive fitness. But we don't maximize reproductive fitness. In fact, birth rates are dropping everywhere. Therefore evolution failed. The standard interpretation is that this shows that alignment is hard. We have one example of an attempt (by evolution) to align the behavior of an intelligent system (us) towards some goal (maximize reproductive fitness). And as soon as that intelligent system (still us) was put in a different environment (modernity) it failed to continue to pursue that goal (you reading existential angst+science blogs instead of making/nurturing babies). To be clear, it's likely good that evolution failed. A world where everyone woke up every day and threw everything they've got into maximizing their number of descendants sounds grim. But say that you want to build a new intelligent system and tune it to do what you want. Will it ke...

8. Invisible Problems

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Mon, 03 Aug 2026 07:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/invisible-problems>

During the pandemic, we completed one of our largest projects at work. To celebrate, since we couldn't meet in person, we all ordered food on DoorDash and played an online escape room game together. We were on a Zoom call, helping each other out and having fun. The first challenge was to escape a jail cell. To escape, each of us had to find clues in our own cell to figure out how to open the doors. We each had to find an object that solved a piece of the puzzle, and once we put them all together, the door would open. As a first challenge, it was easy enough. Everyone found a brightly colored object in their room and described it to the team so we could piece it together. Everyone but one team member. "Come on, read it, man, we can win this." He froze. Someone jumped in to help: "Mine was the most obvious green object in the room. Just look for something bright. Maybe blue, or orange, something that seems out of place." He didn't respond. He just sat there, frozen on camera. We figured he was having internet connectivity issues. We waited a good five minutes before he finally found it, and we moved on to the next level. I didn't think much of that day. We finished the game, we had...

9. Creating a fake agile wrapper that is technically agile but is not useful outside its home apartment, part 1

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 03 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260803-00/?p=112582>

Looking for a COM reference that is between strong and weak. The post Creating a fake agile wrapper that is technically agile but is not useful outside its home apartment, part 1 appeared first on The Old New Thing .

10. Book Review: The Field Guide to Understanding 'Human Error' by Sidney Dekker ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Mon, 03 Aug 2026 11:34:02 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/book-review-the-field-guide-to-understanding-human-error-by-sidney-dekker/>

This is such a useful book. It makes the case that there's no such thing as "human error" - instead most catastrophes are caused by system issues, misaligned incentives, and unrealistic processes. You are not the custodian of an otherwise safe system that you need to protect from erratic human beings. By its nature it is a little repetitive. I suspect it's the sort of book students and?

11. Agentic coding techniques

Source: micahflee | Published: Mon, 03 Aug 2026 16:05:25 GMT

Link: <https://micahflee.com/agentic-coding-techniques/>

Since LLMs have been available, I've been doing a lot of coding using agents. Unlike shoving AI into every app, replacing customer support with chatbots, generating endless streams of slop, etc., agentic coding is actually useful. If used right ? and, crucially, by someone who understands and reviews

12. Why smarter AI models could drive up compute prices 10x

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Mon, 03 Aug 2026 17:32:13 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/why-compute-might-get-10x-more-expensive-video>

The end of cheap compute?

13. Relative velocity and closing speed

Source: Eli Bendersky's website | Published: 2026-08-03T20:01:00-07:00

Link: <https://eli.thegreenplace.net/2026/relative-velocity-and-closing-speed/>

In Physics simulations or game engines it's sometimes useful to determine the speed with which two objects are approaching each other. This post will discuss the concept of closing speed , which is the normal component of the relative velocity of two objects. Relative velocity and its components Suppose we ?

14. Welcoming the Nepalese Government to Have I Been Pwned

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Mon, 03 Aug 2026 06:38:05 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/welcoming-the-nepalese-government-to-have-i-been-pwned/>

Today, we welcome the 47th government onboarded to Have I Been Pwned's free gov service: Nepal. Their National Cyber Security Centre now has access to monitor Nepalese government domains against the data in HIBP. This gives the NCSC the ability to identify exposure across government email addresses and

15. Pluralistic: Dualism (03 Aug 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Mon, 03 Aug 2026 08:25:53 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/08/03/andor/>

Today's links Dualism: Why not both? Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: UK's Great Firewall falls; Mint the coins; Virtual pets v DRM; Getty copyfrauds 47,000 photos; Net Mexico-US illegal migration is zero; Build a wall (around Trump Tower); Remote-hacking big rigs; Collectible AOL CDs; Indefinite Gitmo; Circuit City rips DVDs; Real Names policies are abusive failures; Escher in a water drop; Maximally code-like bugs. Upcoming appearances: Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Dualism (permalink) The greatest magic trick of them all is lying. The reason you can't figure out that coin vanish even after the conjurer performs it three times in a row is that they didn't do the same trick three times in a row! They did three different tricks: "Didn't catch it? Here, let me do it again!" is a lie: <https://magiciansmag.com/3-cool-coin-disappearing-trick/> There's times when it makes sense to treat two outcomes as the same, even if they were produced by very different means....

